A LEARNING PATH FOR CREATORS

# FILM FINANCE

Film finance can look impenetrable because grants, investors, tax credits, pre-sales, distributors and loans are often discussed as though everybody already understands how they fit together. This series starts from zero and builds the picture one piece at a time. Read it in order or jump directly to the subject you need.





NEW TO FILM FINANCE? START HERE.

# HOW DO I GET FUNDING FOR MY FILM?

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A practical guide to finding development funding, understanding eligibility, preparing an application and working out what funders actually want.

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## FILM FUNDS: WHICH ONES ARE ACTUALLY WORTH APPLYING TO?

A practical guide to identifying the right film funds for your project, understanding their criteria and avoiding wasted time on funding that does not fit.

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# FILM GRANTS, DEVELOPMENT FUNDS & PUBLIC FUNDING

Funding programmes, eligibility rules, award levels and application windows change regularly. Check the funder's current guidelines before applying.

## FRANCE

CNC — Centre national du cinéma et de l'image animée — France's principal public film and audiovisual funding body. Covers screenwriting, development, feature production, short films, documentaries, animation, international co-production and distribution.

- Aide au développement d'œuvres cinématographiques de longue durée — Development support for feature projects including writing, rewriting and rights acquisition. Producer-facing.
- Aide aux cinémas du monde (with Institut français) — Support for international feature co-productions involving France. Link: https://www.cnc.fr and https://www.institutfrancais.com
- Fonds Images de la Diversité (with ANCT) — Support for works representing the diversity of French society.
- Fonds d'aide à l'innovation en documentaire de création — Writing and development support for creative documentary projects.
- Short Film Funding — Selective production support for short films.

### Regional Film Funds in France

French regions, departments and cities operate their own film and audiovisual funds, often linked to production expenditure or cultural connections with the territory. Key regional funds include:

- Région Occitanie
- Île-de-France / Pictanovo
- Auvergne-Rhône-Alpes Cinéma
- Nouvelle-Aquitaine
- Bretagne
- Grand Est
- Hauts-de-France / Pictanovo
- Normandie
- Provence-Alpes-Côte d'Azur
- Corsica, Réunion and other overseas territories — check regional authority websites.

## EUROPE & INTERNATIONAL CO-PRODUCTION

Creative Europe MEDIA — European Commission programme supporting audiovisual development, European slate development, TV and online content, distribution, markets, audience development and training across eligible countries. Active 2026 calls confirmed.

Eurimages — Council of Europe fund supporting international co-production of feature films, animation and documentaries. Annual budget approximately €30 million. Active 2026 sessions confirmed.

European Commission Funding & Tenders Portal — Search portal for current Creative Europe and related EU funding calls.

## UNITED KINGDOM

BFI — British Film Institute / National Lottery Filmmaking Fund — Principal source of UK independent film support. £61 million allocated to Filmmaking & Talent Development under the 2026–2029 Funding Plan. Programmes include:

- BFI National Lottery Discovery Feature Funding — Up to £1 million for debut directors. Features with budgets £1m–£3.5m.